

Your six-week checkup

At two to six weeks after the birth, you will have a postpartum visit with your doctor. This checkup will assess your physical and emotional recovery. Your baby will also have a physical and developmental checkup around this time.

Your assessment

In the first couple of months following the birth of their baby, the majority of women don't experience any major health concerns and will revert back to their prepregnant health status. However, it's good practice to have a general assessment to reassure you that you are well and coping with the early transition to motherhood.

Your postpartum checkup is an ideal opportunity for you to consult your doctor about any concerns you have following the birth of your baby. Any worries about yourself, from your mood to any apprehensions about having sex again, can be discussed at this appointment. Your doctor will offer you advice and possibly treatment and will also be able to refer you to a specialist for further treatment if necessary.

Your physical checkup

Your doctor will do routine checkups, such as taking your blood pressure. They will also ask whether you have any concerns and, if you are breastfeeding, whether you've had any problems with your breasts and lactation.

Your uterus will have returned to nearly its prepregnancy size (about the size of the palm of your hand) and will not be able to be felt. However, your doctor may check your abdomen to see whether the muscles are returning to normal since occasionally the abdominal muscles separate after birth, known as "diastasis recti." If the muscles are more than four fingers apart, you may be referred to a physical therapist. Pilates and core conditioning exercises (see [You are 23 weeks and 5 days](#)) can help and your doctor may talk to you about these exercises.

Backaches can be a problem after the birth, exacerbated by the pregnancy hormone [relaxin](#), which softens muscles and ligaments and remains in the body for a few months after pregnancy. If you're suffering from backaches, your doctor may talk to you about your posture, particularly when you're carrying or feeding your baby, and about the benefits of exercise.

If you had a Cesarean, the incision will be looked at to check that it has healed well. You may still feel numbness around the site of the incision, but sensation should gradually return as the nerve endings renew themselves.

If you haven't had a Pap smear in the last three years, you will likely be given one on the spot, unless you're bleeding heavily.